Modeling Bimanual Perceptual Interactions in Macaque Monkeys

Bayesian Hierarchical Modeling

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Outline

Task and Data

Model A: Sessions Pooled
- Model Structure
- Synthetic Data
- Real Data

Model B: Sessions Hierarchical

Model C: Distractor Amplitude as a Covariate

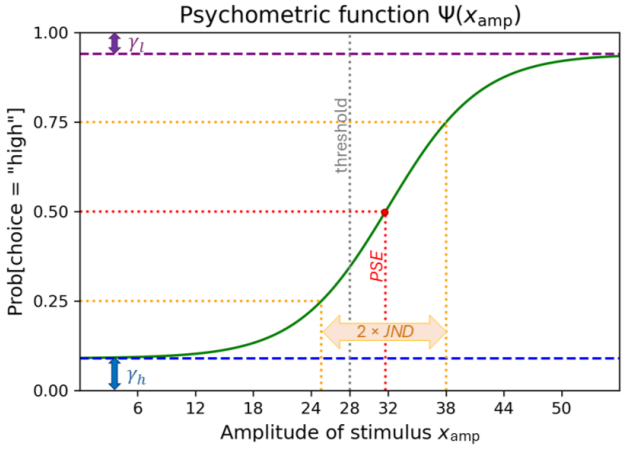
Summary

The task: 2AFC categorization of vibration amplitude

- stimulus $x_{\text{stim}} \in \{6, 12, 18, 24, 32, 38, 44, 50\}\mu m$
  - administered to one finger of one hand (left or right)
- distractor $x_{\text{dist}} \in \{0, x_{\text{d}}\}\mu m$
  - $x_{\text{d}} \in \{6, 12, 18, 24, 32\}\mu m$ value fixed for each session
  - administered to the other (non-stimulus) hand
- if present, distractor administered simultaneously with the stimulus
- monkey categorizes the stimulus as either "high" or "low" relative to a trained boundary of 28 μm.
  - "low" response: correct for $x_{\text{stim}} < 28\mu m$
  - "high" response: correct for $x_{\text{stim}} > 28\mu m$.
- correct responses are rewarded with water or juice

Psychometric function: response $r \sim \text{Bernoulli}(p = \psi)$

$$\psi(x_{\text{stim}}) = \gamma_h + (1 - \gamma_h - \gamma_l)\ \text{logit}^{-1}(\beta_0 + \beta_1 x_{\text{stim}})$$

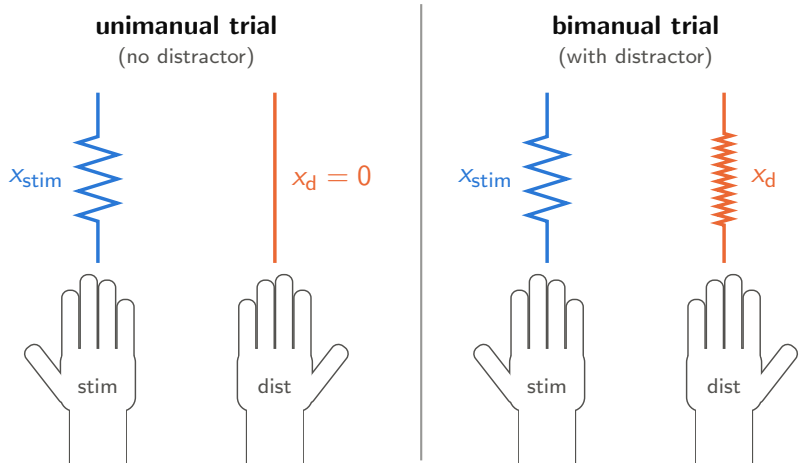


Parameters

$$\psi(x_{\text{stim}}) = \gamma_h + (1 - \gamma_h - \gamma_l)\ \text{logit}^{-1}(\beta_0 + \beta_1 x_{\text{stim}}), \qquad \vec{\theta} = (\beta_0, \beta_1, \gamma_h, \gamma_l)$$

- γ_h: lapse rate for "high"
  - lower bound on $\mathbf{P}(\text{guess} = \text{"high"})$, even to the weakest stimuli
  - lower (left) asymptote of ψ
- γ_l: lapse rate for "low"
  - lower bound on $\mathbf{P}(\text{guess} = \text{"low"})$, even to the strongest stimuli
  - $1 - \gamma_l$ = upper (right) asymptote of ψ
- logit^{-1}: the logistic sigmoid, $\text{logit}^{-1}(z) = \dfrac{1}{1 + \exp(-z)}$
- PSE: stimulus where responses of "high" and "low" are equally likely
  - x_{stim} such that $\psi(x_{\text{stim}}) = 0.5$
  - represents bias
- JND: how much the stimulus needs to change to be noticed half the time
  - half the distance between $\psi(x_{\text{stim}}) = 0.25$ and 0.75
  - represents sensitivity

The task: one trial



Modeling bimanual interactions

- stimulus $x_{\text{stim}} \in \{6, 12, 18, 24, 32, 38, 44, 50\}\mu m$
  - administered to one finger of one hand (left or right)
- distractor $x_{\text{dist}} \in \{0, x_{\text{d}}\}\mu m$
  - $x_{\text{d}} \in \{6, 12, 18, 24, 32\}\mu m$ value fixed for each session
  - administered to the other (non-stimulus) hand
- if present, distractor administered simultaneously with the stimulus
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  - "low" response: correct for $x_{\text{stim}} < 28\mu m$
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- correct responses are rewarded with water or juice

The data

- One monkey (Sirius), 12,937 trials.
- Collected over 42 sessions, averaging approximately 308 trials per session.
- 8 stimulus amplitudes, 6–50 μm; 4 groups: hand $\times$ (unimanual, bimanual).
- Each session uses a single distractor amplitude (6–32 μm) on its bimanual trials.

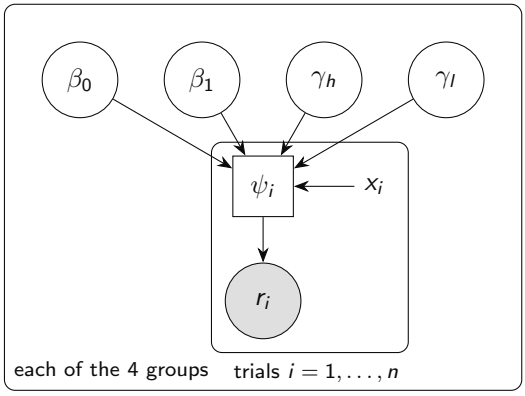
	left hand		right hand		
x_{stim} (μm)	unimanual	bimanual	unimanual	bimanual	total
6	408	404	404	402	1,618
12	407	400	408	400	1,615
18	402	400	403	405	1,610
24	402	405	402	406	1,615
32	404	405	405	407	1,621
38	403	408	404	408	1,623
44	406	403	404	405	1,618
50	405	405	406	401	1,617
total	3,237	3,230	3,236	3,234	12,937

Three models

Model	Sessions	Distractor
A	pooled: one curve per group	uni and bi fit separately
B	hierarchical: one curve per group and session	uni and bi fit separately
C	hierarchical, one group per hand	covariate: shift $\beta_2 d$

For each model: convergence study on synthetic data, then the fit to the real data.

Model A: graphical model



- circles: random variables
- shaded: observed
- rectangles: deterministic
- x_i: fixed covariate
- outer plate: the same model, fit independently to each group

Model A: likelihood

For each group (left/right $\times$ unimanual/bimanual), fit independently to its $n \approx 3{,}230$ trials from all 42 sessions pooled:

Likelihood: probability of obtaining responses $\vec{r}$ given parameters $\vec{\theta} = (\beta_0, \beta_1, \gamma_h, \gamma_l)$
$r_i \sim \textbf{Bernoulli}[\psi(x_i; \vec{\theta})]$ ($r_i = 1$ for "high", x_i standardized), so:

$$\mathbf{P}[r_i = z] = \psi(x_i; \vec{\theta})^z \left(1 - \psi(x_i; \vec{\theta})\right)^{1-z}, \qquad z \in \{0, 1\}$$

$$\begin{aligned} L(\vec{\theta}; \vec{r}) &= \prod_{i=1}^{n} \mathbf{P}[r_i \mid \vec{\theta}] \\ &= \prod_{i=1}^{n} \psi(x_i; \vec{\theta})^{r_i} \left(1 - \psi(x_i; \vec{\theta})\right)^{1-r_i} \end{aligned}$$

Why start here: the simplest model of the experiment. Treating every session as the same curve gives a fast baseline estimate of the distractor's effect on PSE, JND and lapse rates, and its checks tell us whether pooling the sessions is good enough.

Model A: priors

The same priors in every group:

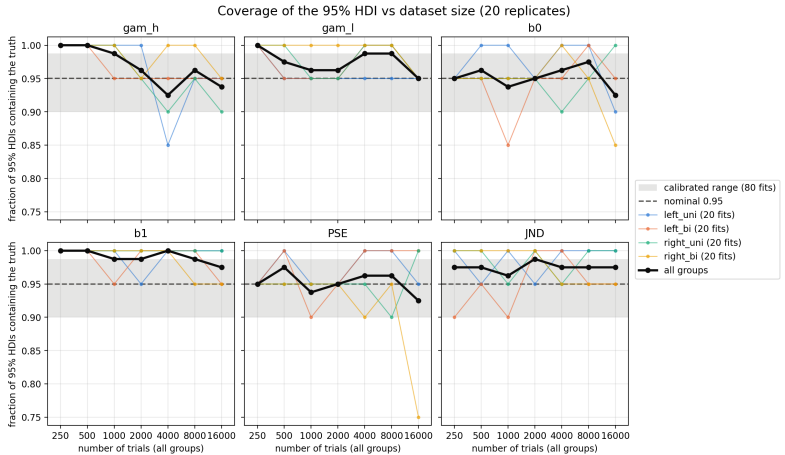
$$\begin{aligned}
\beta_0 &\sim \mathcal{N}(0,\ 6) \\
\beta_1 &\sim \mathcal{N}(4,\ 2) \\
\gamma_h &= 0.25\, w_h, \qquad & w_h &\sim \text{Beta}(1.22,\ 4.89) \\
\gamma_l &= 0.25\, w_l, \qquad & w_l &\sim \text{Beta}(1.22,\ 4.89)
\end{aligned}$$

- Beta with mean 0.2, sd 0.15; scaling by 0.25 keeps each lapse rate in $(0, 0.25)$, so ψ is increasing and the PSE and JND exist
- Implied lapse rate: mean 0.05, 95% range [0.003, 0.141]
- Not checked by prior predictive simulation

Model A on synthetic data: the study

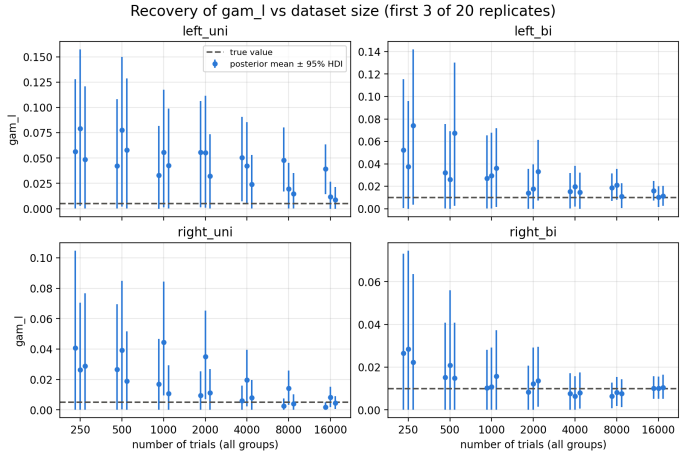
- One fixed set of true parameters per group, with PSE and JND spread over the groups (slopes 3 and 6, γ_h 0.03–0.06, γ_l 0.005–0.01)
- Trials drawn from the real design (the real mix of stimulus levels and groups), responses simulated from the true curves
- 7 sizes: 250 to 16,000 trials; the real data (12,937) lie between the two largest
- 20 replicates of the whole sweep: 140 fits, 80 per size and parameter
- All fits sampled well: $\hat{R} \leq 1.006$, bulk ESS $\geq$ 1,554, one divergence in total

Model A on synthetic data: the 95% HDIs are calibrated



Coverage stays within the calibrated range 0.90–0.99 at every size, except 1.00 where the prior still widens the HDIs.

Model A on synthetic data: γ_l is pulled upward



True γ_l (0.005, 0.01) sits in the prior's lower tail, and the data hold only 3–7 such lapses: the estimates are 1 sd too high at small sizes, 0.36 sd at 16,000.

Model A on synthetic data: what is recoverable

At the size of the real data (about 3,230 trials per group):

- **Recoverable:** PSE, JND, β_0, γ_h: unbiased, calibrated HDIs
  - posterior sd about 0.3 μm for the PSE, 0.2 μm for the JND
- **Recoverable, HDIs a little wide:** β_1 (coverage 0.98–0.99)
- **Not reliably recoverable:** small γ_l
  - biased upward by 0.4–0.5 sd; by about 1 sd when the curve never reaches its ceiling (left_uni), where γ_l trades off with the slope
  - HDIs still cover the truth, but the posterior mean should not be read literally
- **Caveats:** one set of true values; data simulated with one curve per group, so this says nothing about variation between sessions

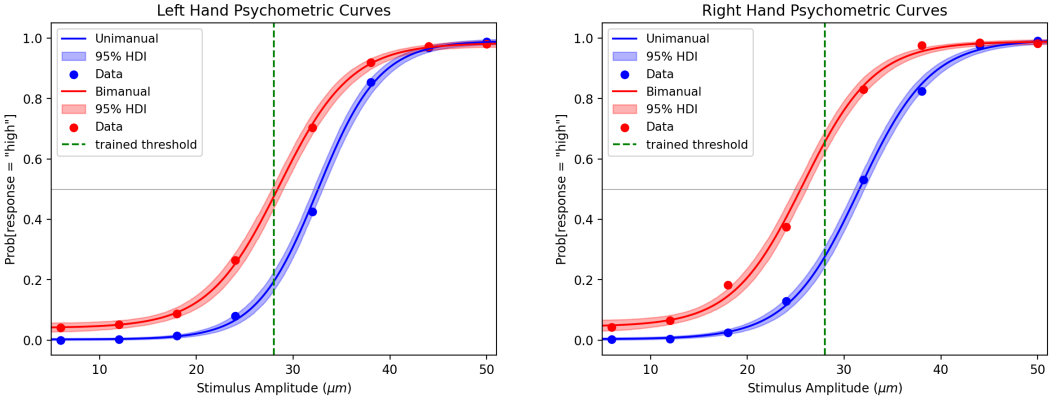
Model A on the real data: group estimates

	PSE (μm)	JND (μm)	γ_h	γ_l
left unimanual	32.58 [32.10, 33.04]	3.56 [3.25, 3.89]	0.002 [0.000, 0.006]	0.009 [0.000, 0.018]
left bimanual	28.38 [27.79, 28.98]	4.39 [3.93, 4.83]	0.041 [0.025, 0.056]	0.016 [0.005, 0.027]
right unimanual	31.57 [31.05, 32.06]	4.09 [3.77, 4.41]	0.003 [0.000, 0.008]	0.006 [0.000, 0.013]
right bimanual	25.50 [24.89, 26.08]	4.36 [3.93, 4.81]	0.045 [0.025, 0.064]	0.012 [0.004, 0.020]

Posterior mean [95% HDI]. 12,937 trials, 4 chains $\times$ 5,000 draws: no divergences, $\hat{R} = 1.000$, bulk ESS $\geq$ 15,213.

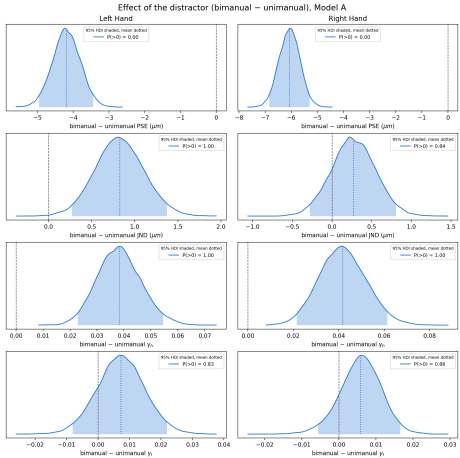
- Without the distractor the PSE lies 3.6–4.6 μm above the trained 28 μm
- With it the PSE moves to the threshold (left) or below it (right)
- γ_l estimates lean high (see the synthetic study)

Model A on the real data: fitted curves



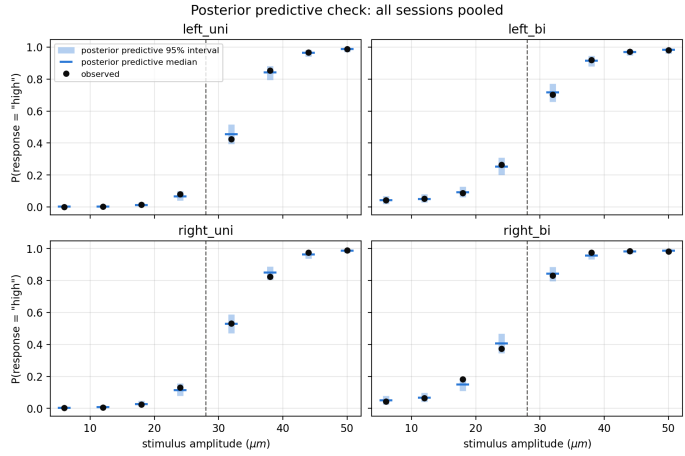
Unimanual in blue, bimanual in red, with the observed proportions pooled over sessions; dashed: the trained threshold of 28 μm.

Model A on the real data: effect of the distractor



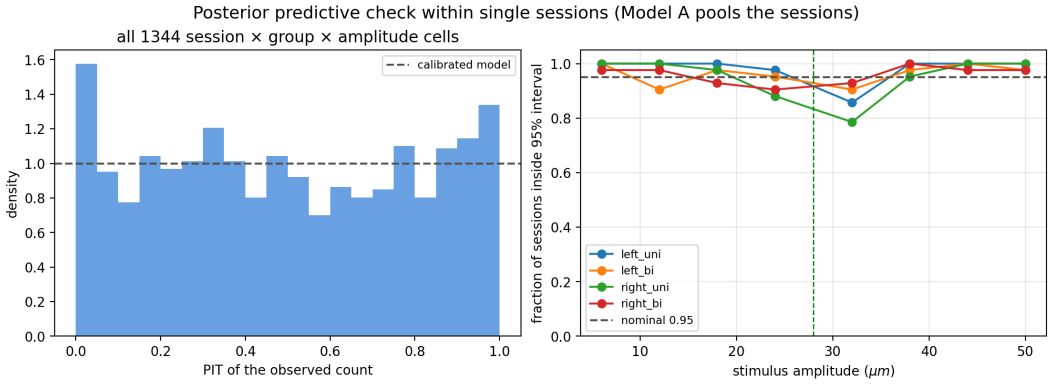
PSE -4.19 $[-4.96, -3.44]$ (left), -6.07 $[-6.85, -5.30]$ (right) μm; γ_h $+0.04$ for both hands; JND $+0.83$ μm (left only).

Model A on the real data: the pooled data are reproduced



Pooled over sessions, all 32 group $\times$ amplitude proportions lie inside their 95% posterior predictive intervals.

Model A misses the variation between sessions



Within sessions, counts vary more than Model A predicts (PIT tails 4.5% and 4.0% vs 2.5%); at 32 μm only 79–86% of sessions are covered.

Model A: conclusions

- Reliable fit; the pooled data are reproduced at every amplitude ($\text{elpd}_{\text{loo}} = -3344.0$, SE 64.5)
- The distractor lowers the PSE by 4.2 (left) and 6.1 (right) μm and raises γ_h by about 0.04
- But the sessions' PSEs differ, and Model A treats that as trial noise:
  - its HDIs are too narrow for the sessions as a whole
  - the pooled JND mixes within-session precision with between-session drift

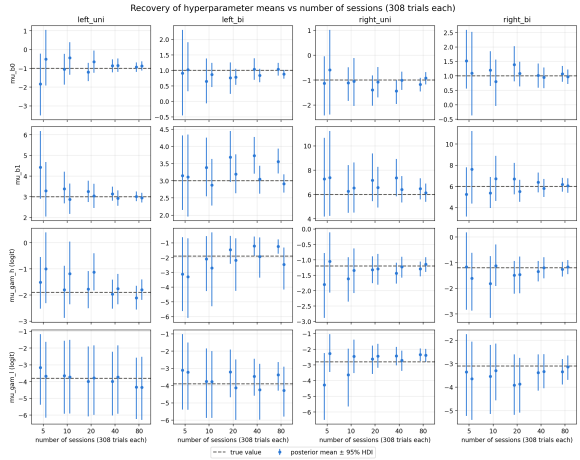
$\Rightarrow$ A curve for every session: Model B

Model B

- A curve for every group *and session*, drawn from group-level distributions (means and between-session sds).
- Design-based priors, checked by prior predictive simulation.

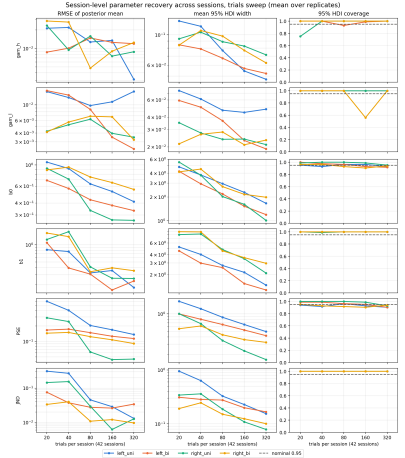
TODO: plate diagram or equations (Convergence_B_Report, "Model Structure")

Model B: convergence on synthetic data



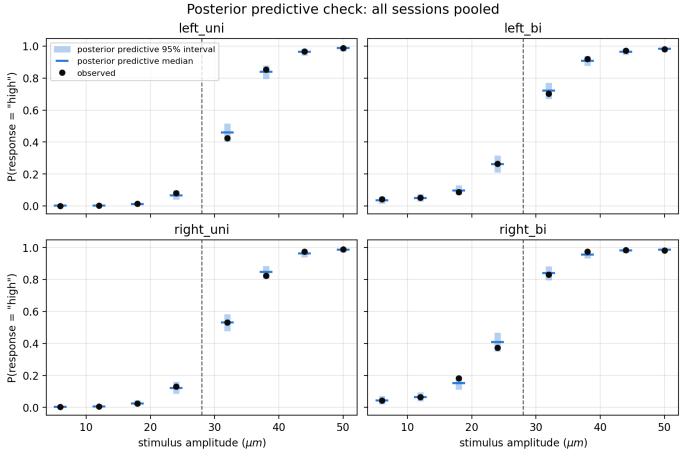
TODO: what is recovered at the real data size (Convergence_B_Report, "Conclusions")

Model B: per-session recovery



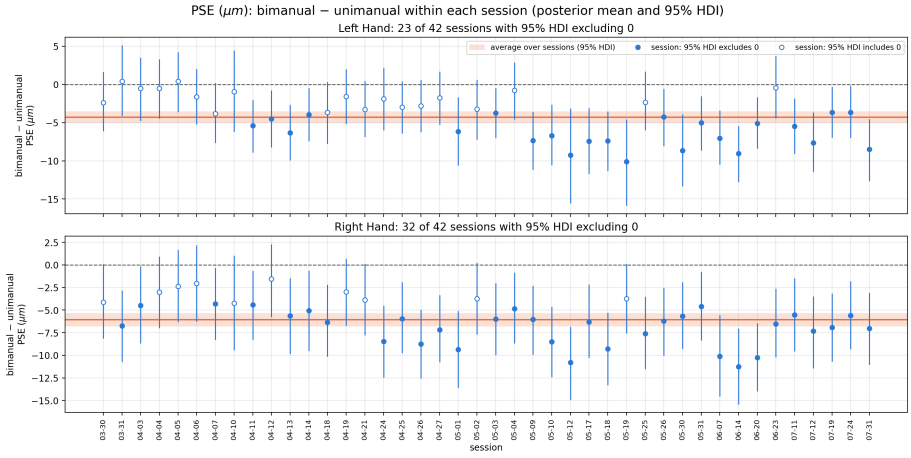
TODO: per-session PSE and JND reliable at ∼300 trials

Model B: fit to the real data



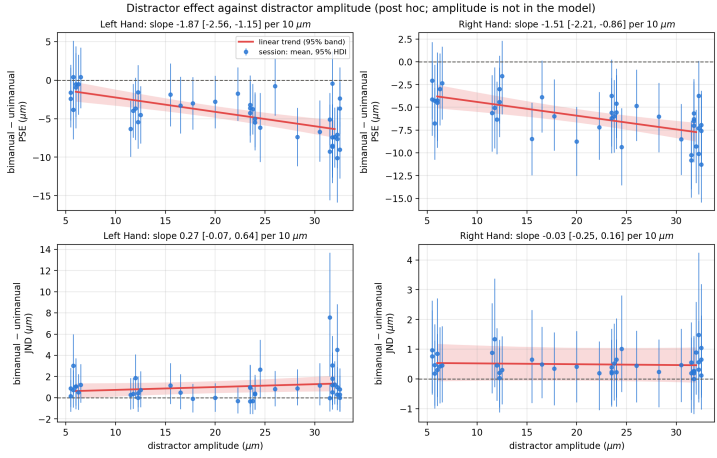
TODO: all 32 proportions inside; 99.8% of session cells (Fit_B_Report, "Posterior predictive checks")

Model B: PSE shift in every session



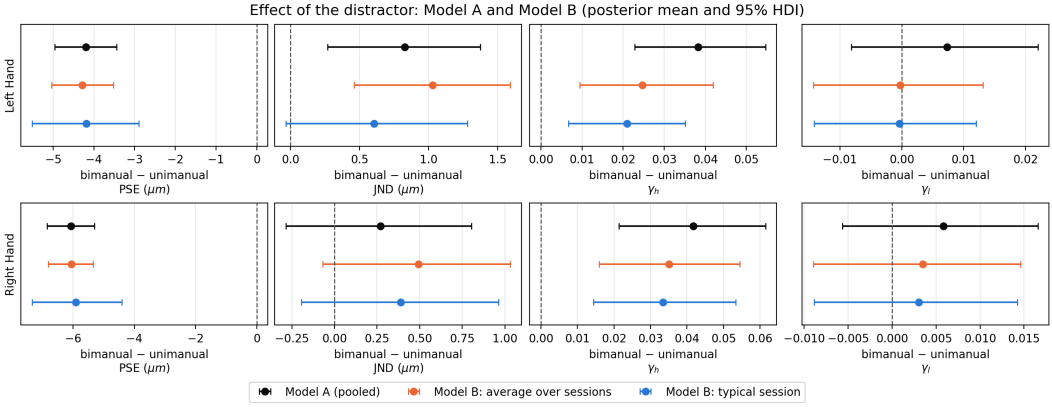
TODO: shift negative in 40/42 (left) and 42/42 (right) sessions (Fit_B_Report, Summary)

Model B: the shift grows with distractor amplitude (exploratory)



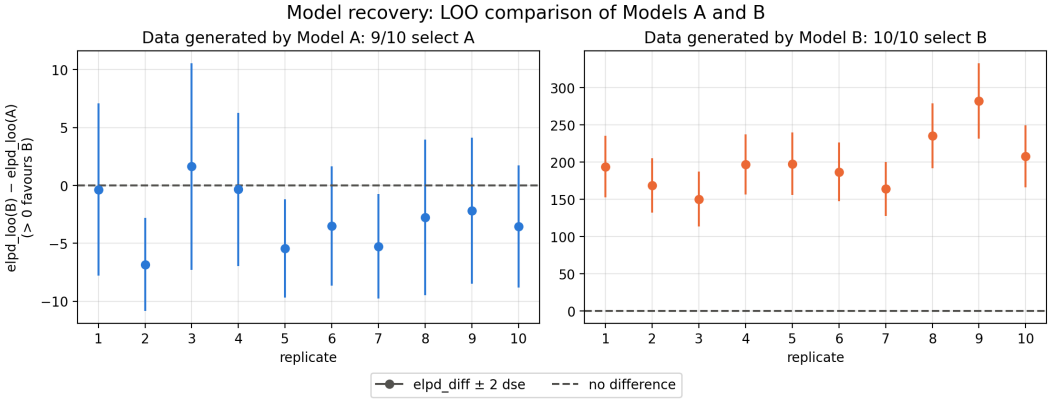
TODO: about -2 μm per 10 μm; confounded with session order

Model B against Model A



TODO: same effects; B better by LOO, 164 (SE 19) (Fit_B_Report, "Comparison with Model A")

Is B's advantage real? Model recovery



TODO: B wins on all data from B, ties or loses on data from A (Model_Recov_BA_Report)

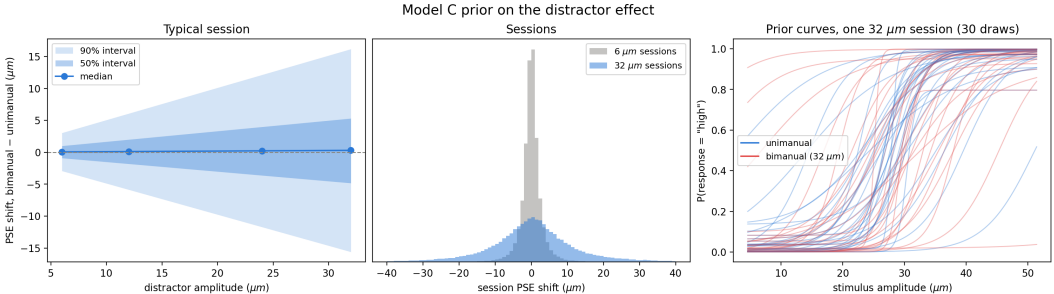
Model C

$$\psi(x, d) = \gamma_h + (1 - \gamma_h - \gamma_l)\ \text{logit}^{-1}(\beta_0 + \beta_1 x + \beta_2 d)$$

- d: distractor amplitude (0 on unimanual trials); one group per hand.
- Uni- and bimanual trials share slope and lapse rates: the distractor only shifts the curve, by an amount proportional to d.

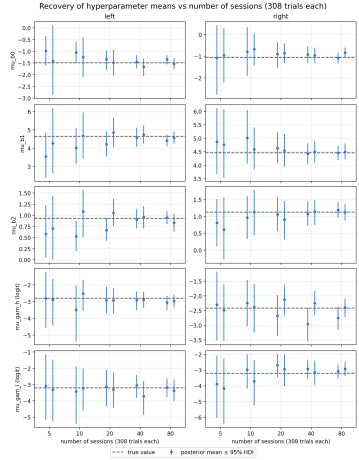
TODO: why: test the amplitude trend from Model B inside a model

Model C: prior on the distractor effect



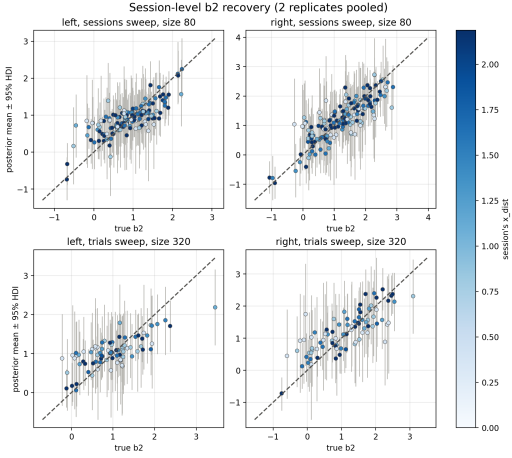
TODO: weakly informative; a weak distractor can only shift a little (Convergence_C_Report)

Model C: convergence on synthetic data



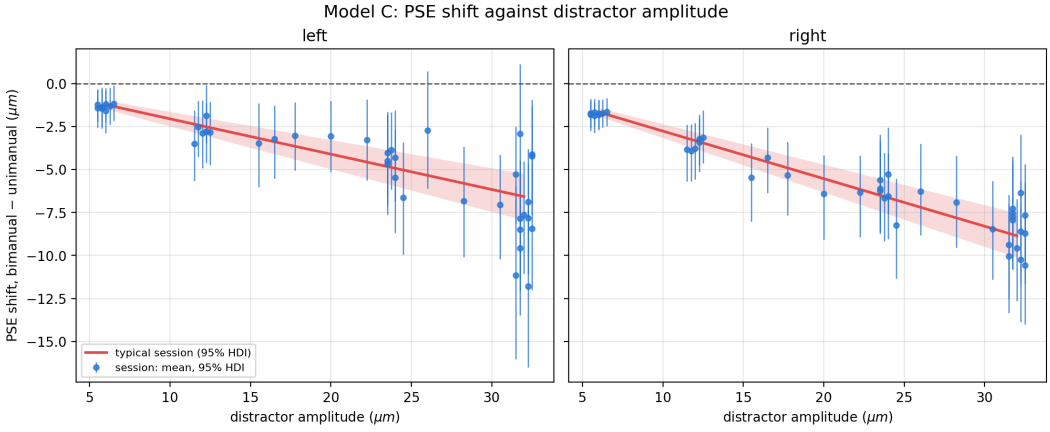
TODO: all hand-level means recovered, μ_{β_2} well (Convergence_C_Report, "Conclusions")

Model C: per-session β_2 is weak for small distractors



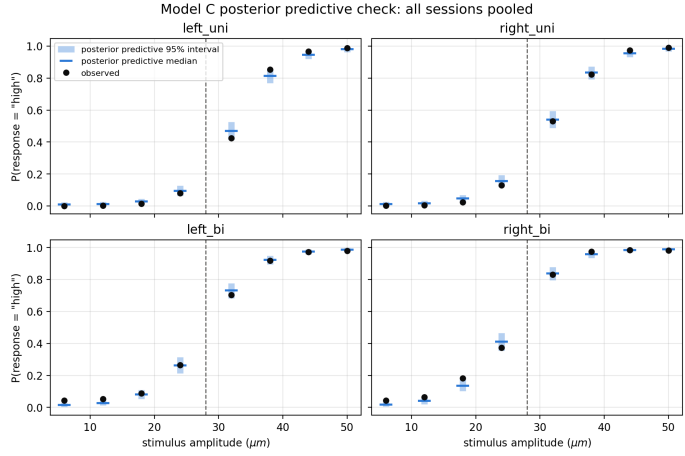
TODO: shrinkage toward the hand mean at 6 μm

Model C: the shift grows with distractor amplitude



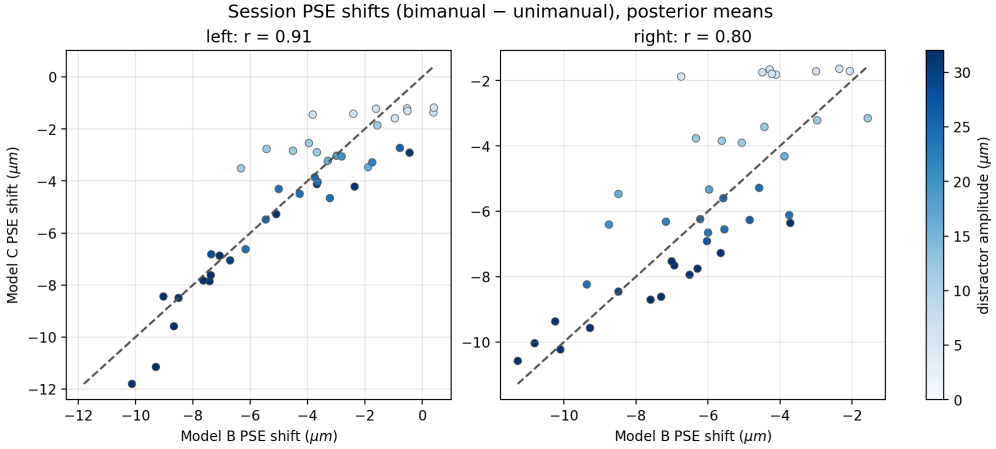
TODO: μ_{β_2} and the typical shift at 6 and 32 μm (Fit_C_Report, "Effect of the Distractor")

Model C misfits at the weakest stimuli



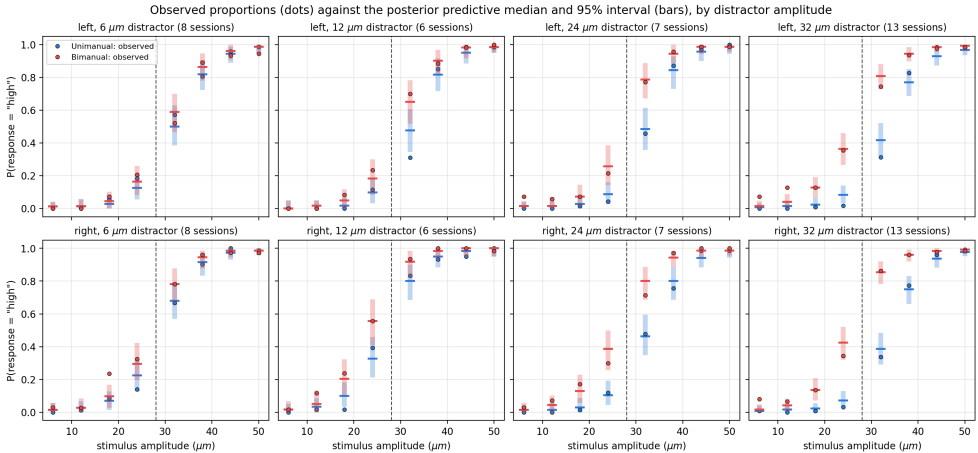
TODO: shared lapse rates: 6 of 32 proportions outside (Fit_C_Report, "Posterior predictive check")

Model C against Model B



TODO: LOO favors B by 37 (SE 12); 6 μm shifts too small (Fit_C_Report, Comparison)

Model C: shift by distractor amplitude, observed vs predicted



TODO: right hand at 6 μm outside: a presence effect (Fit_C_Report, amplitude check)

Comparison of the models

	A	B	C
Sessions	pooled	hierarchical	hierarchical
Distractor	separate groups	separate groups	covariate $\beta_2 d$
elpd_{loo}	**TODO:**	**TODO:**	**TODO:**
PSE shift, left / right (μm)	**TODO:**	**TODO:**	**TODO:**

TODO: fill from Fit_A/B/C_Report; elpd differences from Fit_B and Fit_C

Conclusions

- The distractor lowers the PSE: **TODO:** size, both hands.
- It raises the rate of "high" responses to weak stimuli (γ_h).
- The sessions differ; a hierarchical model is needed.
- The shift grows with distractor amplitude, **TODO:** but not proportionally?

Next steps

- Revise Model C: lapse rates per condition, a distractor-presence term, possibly a bimanual slope.
- Model recovery for B against the revised C.
- **TODO:** further data or experiments